

ספר דובר צדק

DOVER TZEDEK

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- our revered and holy - כְּבוֹד קֹדֶשׁ אֲדָמוֹ"ר שֶׁר הַתּוֹרָה , - with his own holy hands: יְדֵי קֹדֶשׁ
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- who illumined the - מֵאִיר עֵינֵי הַגּוֹלָה , - a radiant lamp of supernal light, בּוֹצִינָא דְּנִהוּרָא עֲלֵאָה ,
- a man of God renowned throughout the ends of - אִישׁ אֱלֹקִים הַמְּפֹרָס בְּכָל קִצְוֵי אֶרֶץ , - eyes of the exile,
- whose holy name spread abroad like poured oil: - כְּשֶׁמֶן תּוֹרָה נִשְׁפָּךְ , - רַבֵּינוּ צְדוֹק הַכֹּהֵן
- our teacher Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen of Lublin, of blessed and saintly - נִבְגַּ"מ זְצוּקֵלְלָהּ"ה מְלוֹבְבִין
memory, - זי"ע וְעַכְ"א , - may his merit protect us and all Israel, amen.

Dover Tzedek

An Elucidated Bilingual Edition • Volume One • Eruvin, Berachos, Ner HaMitzvot, Mishlei, Ki Savo, and Vayeishev

This volume presents, in elucidated bilingual form, Kuntres Dover Tzedek on Eruvin and Berachos; Kuntres Ner HaMitzvot, comprising the Hakdamah and the discourse on Parashat Bereishis; Kuntres Mishlei, comprising the discourses on Chapter Ten and Chapter One; and the Likutim discourses on Ki Savo / Bikkurim and Vayeishev. The Likutim discourses on Avodah Zarah and Acharei Mos appear in Volume II.

The Hebrew text of the author is presented with full vocalization (nikkud), followed by a close English rendering in bold and an interwoven elucidation in scholarly register. Talmudic, Midrashic, Zoharic, and cross-textual sources are supplied in the footnotes, together with parallel passages from R' Tzadok's broader corpus.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, and formatting. All sources, citations, and interpretations follow the original Hebrew text; readers are encouraged to consult the underlying Hebrew of the original Dover Tzedek directly.

Original work Dover Tzedek by Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin (1823–1900).

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דובר צדק

Dover Tzedek

קונטרס דובר צדק

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עירובין

Eruvin

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סעיף א' - Se'if 1

Mishkan and Mikdash: Shekhinah, Mitzvot, and Divine Indwelling

Eruvin, chapter one (2a): - **We find that the Mishkan is called a Mikdash, and so forth.**¹ **This explains the formula, “for the sake of the unification of the Holy One, blessed be He, and His Shekhinah,”** שכתב - **about which Responsa Havot Yair, section 210, writes** - **that its meaning was unknown to him.**² **Its straightforward meaning is as follows.** (Berakhot 35b), **the Sages teach:** - **his “Father” is the Holy One, blessed be He, and his “mother” is Knesset Israel.** - **Knesset Israel is the mother and the fountain of the root** - **from which all the individual souls of Israel unfold and are born.**³ **It is well known from “the Lord’s portion is His people”** - **that the souls of Israel are a divine portion.** **As Scripture says, “He breathed into his nostrils”:** - **one who breathes**

1 Talmudic premise - Mishkan and Mikdash: Eruvin 2a:13-14 states, "We find a Mishkan that is called Mikdash, and a Mikdash that is called Mishkan." In context, the Gemara uses the shared terminology to test whether the dimensions of a Temple doorway can define the entrance to an eruv alleyway. Rav Tzadok turns that legal equivalence into the conceptual doorway of the discourse: the external sanctuary and the inward indwelling can disclose one reality. Eruvin 2a:13-14 The legal discussion is about whether one sacred structure can supply the dimensional model for another. Rav Tzadok hears a metaphysical principle inside that transfer: two forms may differ in permanence, historical function, and human experience while nevertheless expressing one underlying kedushah. That move becomes the controlling method of the opening se'if and prepares the later contrast between Shekhinah as indwelling disclosure and the transcendent divine Source.

2 Havot Yair and the formula. Rabbi Yair Hayyim Bacharach (1638-1702) records that an ordinary reader asked him to explain the prefatory formula recited before tallit and tefillin, 'for the sake of the unification of the Holy One, blessed be He, and His Shekhinah.' He answered candidly that he did not understand the formula's ultimate intent and warned against reconstructing kabbalistic secrets from books without a received tradition. Rav Tzadok therefore offers a peshat - an accessible conceptual meaning - without claiming to exhaust the formula's esoteric content. His account presents mitzvah-action as reuniting the consciously experienced, finite life of the worshipper with the Divine Source from which that life derives, without implying any change or division in God Himself. Havot Yair 210:22-23.

3 Father, mother, and Knesset Israel: Berakhot 35b:2:2 calls the Holy One, blessed be He, the person's "Father" and Knesset Israel his "mother," deriving the images from Deuteronomy 32:6 and Proverbs 1:8. In the Gemara, one who enjoys the world without a blessing is described as robbing both. Rav Tzadok reads the rabbinic metaphor ontologically: Knesset Israel is the collective soul and proximate matrix through which individual Jewish souls become manifest, while their ultimate source remains God. Berakhot 35b Rav Tzadok turns a moral image from the sugya of berakhot into a model of spiritual genealogy. 'Father' marks the unconditional divine source; 'mother' marks Knesset Yisrael as the collective, immanent vessel in which that life is received and individuated. The metaphor lets him explain how a soul can be genuinely particular and embodied while remaining rooted in a source beyond individuality. This becomes the basis for his account of mitzvah as return and renewed birth. Exact Yisrael Kedoshim 8:13. Rav Tzadok describes the holiness bestowed to each Jewish soul as 'the portion of that soul in its root'; he then identifies Knesset Yisrael with the holiness rooted in Jewish hearts, derives the souls of Israel from the Divine breath, and says that each soul unites with its corresponding root above. This is an unusually close internal witness to the architecture of the present se'if: collective 'mother,' transcendent source, Divine breath, and individual rootedness are not separate metaphors but facets of one account of how finite Jewish life remains joined to its Source. Yisrael Kedoshim 8:13.

breathes from within himself.⁴ - וכמ"ש ונתתי מלשכני בתוךכם - Likewise: "I will place My dwelling within you," - and, "I am the Lord," - השוכן אִתָּם - "Who dwells among them." הוא - השוכן בקרב כליות ולב - dwelling in the inward being and heart - of the souls of Israel.⁵ - והוא דנקרא שכינה בכל מקום - It is this indwelling presence that is everywhere called the Shekhinah. - וגלו לבבל שכינה עמָהֶם כו - when Israel was exiled to Babylonia, the Shekhinah went with them. - וקסנהדרין (מו) - And Sanhedrin (46a) asks: שכינה מה - שכינה מה - As Megillah (29a) teaches: כו - כמ"ש במגילה (כט). - when a person suffers, what does the Shekhinah say? "My head is burdened," and so forth.⁶ - לפי שהוא התגלות ד - For the Shekhinah is the disclosure of the Lord בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל - השוכן בתוך בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל - Who dwells within the Children of Israel and remains in their midst forever. - ובקרבם לעולם וקמולם - from the Western Wall (Shemot Rabbah, chapter 2).⁷ - מכותל מערבי (שמו"ר פ"ב) - This is the wall where the light sets. - היא הכותל ששם שקיעת האור - That is, at the wall nearest the setting sun, רוצה לומר בכותל שסמוך לשקיעה - והוא לקנות ערב ועת - the Shekhinah does not withdraw - השכינה לא וזה - as evening approaches and darkness begins, [מכותל שהיא המושען לאיש] - [from the wall that supports a person]. כמ"ש (יזמא נ"ו) השוכן - So Yoma (57a) says that He "dwells among them in the midst of their impurities."⁸ - כי נפשות כל ישראל אוחזים וקשורים בבשלת - For all the souls of Israel are held and

4 The divine soul and the breath metaphor: Genesis 2:7 says that God "breathed into his nostrils the breath of life," while Deuteronomy 32:9 calls Israel "the Lord's portion." The kabbalistic maxim "one who breathes, breathes from within himself" is often cited in later works as Zoharic; Mei HaShiloach identifies Sefer HaKanah and joins it to "You shall be holy, for I am holy." Rav Tzadok repeatedly explains the same complex: Sichat Malakhei HaSharet 1:20 says the soul proceeds from divine inwardness, and 2:9 links this to Israel being called children. "Portion" here does not mean a material fragment or division in God; it describes derivation, intimacy, and an indestructible relation to the divine source. Genesis 2:7 Deuteronomy 32:9 Mei HaShiloach II, Kedoshim 2 Sichat Malakhei HaSharet 1:20; 2:9 The breath image supplies both intimacy and dependence. Breath comes 'from within' yet remains wholly dependent on the breather; similarly, the soul is not an autonomous divine fragment but a created life whose deepest root points beyond itself. Rav Tzadok can therefore speak strongly of an indestructible Jewish root while still preserving the absolute Creator-creature distinction. That balance is essential for the later claim that sin can obscure or constrict revelation without severing the deepest relation to its Source.

5 The inward Mishkan: Leviticus 26:11 promises, "I will place My dwelling among you." Rashi and Ramban read mishkani primarily as the sanctuary, while Sforno emphasizes the Shekhinah dwelling among Israel wherever they may be. Or HaChaim goes further and reads God's dwelling as the souls of His holy people. Rav Tzadok gathers these senses together: the historical Mishkan becomes a model for the divine life present in the inward being of Israel. Leviticus 26:11 Or HaChaim on Leviticus 26:11 The shift from building to person is not decorative homily. It explains why the Mishkan can serve as the model for a human life: the sanctuary is the public form of the same pattern that mitzvah is meant to establish inwardly. A dwelling is a place in which presence becomes recognizable. Rav Tzadok's point is therefore not that the human being literally becomes a Temple, but that disciplined avodah creates a stable vessel in which divine vitality can be consciously received. Exact Rav Tzadok and Izhbitz-Radzin parallels — Tzidkat HaTzadik §251 says that a person becomes a vessel for the indwelling of the Shekhinah through the heart's holy longing, and explicitly calls this 'the building of the Mishkan of the Shekhinah below'; each person experiences that Mishkan according to what his heart can receive. Tiferet Yosef, Bamidbar, on 'Se'u et rosh,' gives the school parallel: one may labor in Torah until one becomes a Mishkan in which Hashem rests His Shekhinah, while the necessity of every board of the Mishkan teaches the irreplaceable significance of every Jewish soul. These texts confirm that Rav Tzadok's inward-Mishkan language is a recurring doctrine, not a one-off metaphor. Tzidkat HaTzadik §251; Tiferet Yosef, Bamidbar, s.v. 'Se'u et rosh.'

6 Exile and suffering: Megillah 29a:4:4 teaches that when Israel went into Babylonian exile, "the Shekhinah was with them." Sanhedrin 46a:15:15 makes the claim personal: when a human being suffers, the Shekhinah says, "My head is burdened; My arm is burdened." Rav Tzadok places the national and individual teachings side by side to define Shekhinah as divine presence that remains bound to Israel precisely where concealment and pain might suggest abandonment. Megillah 29a Sanhedrin 46a These two sugyot prevent a simplistic equation of Shekhinah with spiritual success. Divine accompaniment is asserted precisely in exile and suffering, where revelation is least obvious. For Rav Tzadok this explains how inward divine life can remain present even when the person experiences darkness, punishment, or distance. The hidden presence is what makes later return possible: concealment changes the mode of awareness, not the ultimate Source of the life that is concealed.

7 The Western Wall at sunset: Shemot Rabbah 2:2 says, "The Shekhinah never departs from the Western Wall," and connects it to Song of Songs 2:9, "He stands behind our wall." Rav Tzadok adds a homiletical layer: west is the direction of sunset, so the wall represents the limit at which illumination gives way to darkness. The Midrash asserts enduring presence at a place; Rav Tzadok converts that place into an inner condition of obscurity in which the Shekhinah still supports the person. Shemot Rabbah 2:2 The sunset image sharpens the transition from visible illumination to hidden support. Rav Tzadok repeatedly treats night, exile, and constriction as conditions in which emunah must carry what direct perception no longer can. The Western Wall therefore becomes a symbol of the last visible boundary of revelation: even where the 'sun' of apprehension sets, a residual point of attachment remains. This anticipates his later use of boundaries throughout Eruvin as spiritual forms rather than mere limitations.

8 Within impurity: Leviticus 16:16 describes the Tent of Meeting as "dwelling with them in the midst of their impurities." Sifra Acharei Mot and Yoma 57a:1:1 make the implication explicit: even when Israel is impure, the Shekhinah remains among them; Rashi repeats that reading. This is not permission to remain impure. It is the

bound together like a chain, as suggested by “Jacob, the rope of His inheritance” (ע"י במד"ר פ"ט) - (see Bemidbar Rabbah, chapter 9). Consequently, the revelation of divine light, even under profound concealment, hiddenness, and contraction, is never entirely absent from any Jewish heart. - אף הפחות שבפחותים יש בו חלק חיים. - allotted to him by the Lord from the divine portion above.⁹ The Shekhinah is therefore spoken of everywhere in the feminine, - כי היא במדרגת אם כנ"ל, - because she occupies the role of mother, as explained above.¹⁰ וא"א כמ"ש כי לא יראני האדם, - והיינו כי בראמת עצם אור ד' גדול מאוד - and cannot be grasped at all by the human heart, - להיות מושג ללב בני אדם קלל - This transcendent aspect is expressed by the title “the Holy One, blessed be He.” - ותהי תואר הקב"ה - as Scripture says: “A human being cannot see Me and live.” - הוראת גדושה בכל מקום - He is separate from human beings and their comprehension.¹¹ - והיינו אור ד' הנבדל מלבבות הישראל - This refers to the light of the Lord as it transcends Jewish hearts. - ולפי שרצה ית"ש - Yet the Blessed One desired that created beings should apprehend something of His light. - גם כן מאודו - He therefore contracted His illumination - שמהלל מוגבלת ומצומצמת - so that it would become bounded and limited, - ולא בתוקף וחזק כ"כ, - rather than overwhelming in force and intensity. [This attenuation of force is sometimes indicated by feminine language. - נרמז בכל מקום בלשון נקבה - The Sages use this grammatical explanation in comparable cases: in Berakhot (32a), - [יכולת יכול מבועי ל' תשש כחו בנקבה כו - the feminine form signifies that, as it were, “His power weakened,” and so forth.] - והוא כח אור שבינתו ית' - This contracted illumination is the light of His Shekhinah within the hearts of Israel.¹² - כפי גדול החיים הנצחיים שבנפשות בני - Just as a mother raises her child, - ובענין האם המגדלת בנה

theological basis of return: impurity obscures the indwelling but does not erase the relationship that makes purification possible. Leviticus 16:16 Yoma 57a Rashi on Leviticus 16:16 The source establishes a crucial theological asymmetry: impurity is real and must be removed, but it does not possess the power to make the covenantal relation unreal. Rav Tzadok needs that distinction for his developmental model of avodah. Mitzvot purify because there is already a divine-rooted life capable of being uncovered. The Shekhinah 'within their impurity' is therefore not indulgence toward sin; it is the metaphysical condition that makes teshuvah, purification, and renewed apprehension possible.

9 Jacob as a rope: Deuteronomy 32:9 calls Jacob "the rope of His inheritance." Bemidbar Rabbah 9:7 describes Israel's generations as strands intertwined into a rope and depicts grave sin as cutting that rope. Rav Tzadok stresses the other side of the image: all Jewish souls remain linked in a single chain of inheritance. His Yisrael Kedoshim 10:7 similarly joins "God made the human upright," the divine breath, and "Jacob, the rope of His inheritance," to argue that even extensive sin cannot convert Israel's essential root into that of the nations. Bemidbar Rabbah 9:7 Yisrael Kedoshim 10:7 A rope is made of separate strands whose strength lies in their binding. Rav Tzadok uses that image to hold together individuality, history, and collective rootedness: a single soul may become obscured, but it belongs to a larger continuity that precedes its present state. This helps explain why Knesset Yisrael can function as 'mother.' The individual is born into a living corporate relation, and mitzvah reconnects the conscious self with that inherited depth rather than constructing holiness from nothing.

10 Shekhinah as mother: The feminine designation is symbolic and grammatical, not a claim that God is bodily or sexed. Here "mother" names the immanent and nurturing mode through which hidden divine vitality becomes present, grows, and is differentiated in souls. The metaphor continues the rabbinic language of Berakhot 35b:2:2 and prepares Rav Tzadok's distinction between the transcendent source, called "father," and its contracted, inwardly manifest disclosure, called "mother" or Shekhinah. Berakhot 35b The maternal metaphor describes mediation, not a second divine power. It gives language for the passage from concealed source to received life: what is beyond all measure must be disclosed through a vessel proportioned to the recipient. That is why Rav Tzadok can identify Shekhinah with both Knesset Yisrael and the indwelling divine life. In each case the emphasis is on reception and manifestation, while the ultimate life remains rooted in the transcendent 'Father.'

11 Unknowability and holiness as separation: Exodus 33:20 says, "A human being cannot see Me and live." Ramban explains that the embodied soul could not sustain such apprehension, and Sforno likewise reads the verse as a limit of mortal perception. Maharal defines kedushah as separation from material existence: God is called holy because He is not one being alongside created beings. Rav Tzadok therefore hears HaKadosh Barukh Hu as a title for divine transcendence, prior to the contracted disclosure that can be borne within consciousness. Exodus 33:20 Ramban on Exodus 33:20 Gevurot Hashem 30:2 Rav Tzadok's next move depends on this limit. If the divine essence were directly graspable, there would be no need for mediated indwelling, mitzvah, or progressive apprehension. Kedushah as separation therefore does not produce distance for its own sake; it explains why finite vessels are necessary. The Shekhinah is the merciful form of disclosure by which the utterly transcendent can be encountered without ceasing to be transcendent or overwhelming the creature who receives the light.

12 Tzimtzum and the Talmudic idiom: Rav Tzadok uses tzimtzum for the limitation of overwhelming illumination into a form that creatures can apprehend; the passage speaks phenomenologically about revelation, not about spatial change in God. The bracketed line cites Berakhot 32a:28:28, where the feminine noun yekholet, "ability," is contrasted with the masculine yakhol, "able," and the Sages employ the old rhetorical phrase "His strength weakened like a female." Rav Tzadok borrows that grammatical trope solely for diminished or contracted manifestation. It is not a

by the light - הוא אור השוכן בם - **Israel is nurtured** - so the eternal life within the souls of Israel
dwelling within them. Through that light, every dimension - ועל ידו מתנהגים כל ענניי החיים האמתיים -
of true life is directed, including the distinction between human beings and animals. - והבדלים מן הבהמות
Yet their primary root, from which they were implanted in the world, - אבל עקר ושורש אשר ממנו השתלו בעולם.
[The visible implantation is from the mother who gives birth, but in hidden fashion the implantation comes from the father, from whom she receives it, - כי ההשתלה הגלויה מן האם המולדת] - אבל בהעלם באה ההשתלה מן האב,
and it is [שמקובלת ממנו ולא נודע כי באו אלא קרובה, - and it is not perceptible that it has entered her inward being.] That concealed root comes from the essential transcendent light, which generates every divine soul-portion in potential and entrusts it to the Shekhinah, the power of contraction. - ונותנים להשכינה שהוא כח הצמצום
That is, the Blessed One established a power through which the light could be contracted and emerge into felt actuality - רוצה לומר הכח שישך השי"י - שיצומצם ויוכל לצאת לפועל גרגש
as an apprehension of Him within the human heart. - אוֹר הַשְּׁגָחוֹ יְה' בִּלְבָב בְּנֵי אָדָם - That power of the Shekhinah gives birth and brings the hidden potential into actuality. - ואותו כח השכינה
This is the meaning of "his Father is the Holy One, blessed be He."¹³ - יְתָה פִּי אֲבִיו זֶה הַקֹּב"ה ,

it - הוא על ידי חלק חיים השוכן בתוכנו - Now, in every performance of the mitzvot, והנה כל מעשה המצוות
it is through the portion of life dwelling within us - that we serve the King of Glory, והקב"ה הנבדל מכל גשם וחופף עלינו
the Holy One, blessed be He, Who transcends all physicality and shelters over us. - ותהיה כן - That is: תכלית השלימות - the purpose of perfection
ברבוי יותר מרגש - is an ever-increasing revelation of the Blessed One's light, והספות התגלות אור הש"י
- until "all my bones shall say: Lord, who is like You?" - עד כי כל עצמותי תאמרנה ד' מי כמוך
For this purpose the Blessed One commanded statutes and ordinances. - ועל זה צוה הש"י תקנים ומשפטים
In accordance with the order of supernal wisdom, על ידי יתדכחו הנפשות והתלכבות, they refine souls and hearts
ויסירו עד שיורגש יותר ויתרבה החלק האלק' ממעל, ועל ידי יתדכחו הנפשות והתלכבות, and remove the screens that divide, והמסכים המבדילים
והיינו שיוגד - until the divine portion above within a person is felt more fully and increases.¹⁴ - לשקרב לבו
an additional measure of light and apprehension of the Blessed One - עוד חלק אור והשגת הש"י - That is, there is born within the heart
through every act of divine service. , בכל עבודה ועבודה - Every birth is through father and mother: וכל לידה היא על ידי אב ואם
into the contracted light - עוד אור נוסף באור המצומצם - a new illumination flows from the light of His glory
within the heart's perception, , בקרב השגת לבו להשיג יותר מאמתות אור ונשפע הש"י על פני תבל
enabling it to grasp more of the truth of the Blessed One's light and influx throughout the world.
as (קדושין ל"א), [This is the purpose of the contracted light, שנהיה תכלית אור המצומצם]
the person and his mother are obligated to honor his father. - [שהוא ואמו חייבין בכבוד אביו - Kiddushin (31a) teaches:]
Through the performance of mitzvot, ועל ידי מעשה המצוות - שעובד בכח חיותו ושכלו

statement about women's spiritual dignity or capacity. Recanati on Shelach also treats the phrase as an esoteric allusion rather than a crude comparison. Berakhot 32a Recanati on Shelach 6 The note is also a safeguard against reading tzimtzum as literal spatial withdrawal. Rav Tzadok's concern is the scale of manifestation: an infinite light can be experienced only through a contracted form proportionate to the receiver. The unusual gendered idiom in the Bavli serves only as inherited language for diminution of manifest power. The theological point is therefore about reception and concealment, not divine weakness, corporeality, or any essential hierarchy between male and female persons.

13 Hidden father and manifest mother: Rav Tzadok's *Sichat Malakhei HaSharet* 2:9 describes Israel's souls as proceeding "from the very power of the Father" and connects the divine breath to Israel's status as children. In the present passage the father is the transcendent source held in potential; the mother is Shekhinah, the contracted power that receives, gestates, and brings that potential into felt actuality. The biological analogy is deliberately marked as an analogy of hidden source and manifest birth, not a literal description of divine structure. *Sichat Malakhei HaSharet* 2:9 This analogy explains the 'birth' language at the end of the se'if. A hidden source is not yet a consciously possessed apprehension; it must pass through a receptive, formative stage before it becomes manifest in the person. Rav Tzadok uses father and mother to distinguish origin from emergence. *Mitzvah* performed by the living soul is thus a kind of spiritual gestation: the rooted divine relation becomes newly articulated in awareness, character, and action.

14 Mitzvot as refinement: The language of refining souls, removing screens, and reaching devekut belongs to a broad Jewish ethical and mystical grammar. Mesillat Yesharim, chapter 1, presents commandments as the means by which a person reaches attachment to God and true perfection. Tanya, chapter 23, describes the limbs performing a mitzvah as a vehicle for the supernal will. Rav Tzadok's distinctive emphasis is developmental: each mitzvah removes an obstruction and permits an additional measure of already-rooted divine life to be born into conscious apprehension. Mesillat Yesharim 1 Tanya 23 Mesillat Yesharim and Tanya help locate Rav Tzadok between two familiar models: ethical refinement and mystical union. He combines them. The mitzvah removes opacity from the receiver, but the result is not merely moral improvement; the clarified person becomes more capable of apprehending the divine life already sustaining him. This is why his language of 'screens' should be read dynamically: each act changes the vessel and thereby changes what measure of truth the person can consciously bear.

הַמְּשֻׁגָּל לְלִבּוֹ וּמוֹחוֹ הַמְּצֻמָּצְמִים עוֹבֵד לְחַיֵּי - **a person serves with the vitality and intellect available to him** - **and with his bounded heart and mind serves the Life of the world, the living God and everlasting King.** - **The portion of life dwelling within him thereby becomes united and joined** - **with the Source of life.** - **Through this union a new birth of additional apprehension takes place.** - **This is the meaning of** - **for the sake of the unification of the Holy One, blessed be He, and His Shekhinah.**¹⁵

Se'if 2 - סְעִיף ב'

Fear and Love: The Inner Wings of Mitzvah

וְנִגְזַר בְּדַחֲלֵי וְדַחֲמֵי וְדַחֲמֵי וְדַחֲמֵי - **And the meaning of the formula “with fear and love, and with love and fear”**¹⁶ - **is reflected in Scripture’s order: “Honor your father and your mother,”** - **while another verse says, “Each person shall reverence his mother and his father.”** - **The Sages’ close reading in Kiddushin (there) is well known.**¹⁷ - **The underlying idea is expressed in Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 10): “Father” and “mother” are the two wings,** - **and Torah without fear and love does not fly aloft.**¹⁸ - **Here “flight” means that the act is received willingly before Him, blessed be He,** - **so that there is immediately born within the person an influx of renewed apprehension.** - **This occurs only through the aforementioned union of father and mother.**¹⁹

15 Har Bracha preserves the full yichud formula at both the opening and the conclusion of this se'if. That fuller reading is important because Rav Tzadok identifies the transcendent Source as the “Father” and Knesset Yisrael, the indwelling Shekhinah, as the “Mother”; mitzvah reunites finite, indwelling life with its Source. Kiddushin 31a supplies the father-mother analogy. Tzidkat HaTzadik §252 provides a close internal control: yichud means recognizing human willing and action as rooted in the Divine Source, not effecting any change in God.

16 Fear and love: The paired Aramaic formulas describe two directions of service: awe establishes receptivity; love supplies movement toward God. Sha'ar Ma'amarei Rashbi explains that kabbalistic texts reverse their order according to the direction of unification and the flow of apprehension. Rav Tzadok develops this further in Se'if 3. Sha'ar Ma'amarei Rashbi, Ki Tissa 3 The reversal of the formula is not redundancy. It indicates that spiritual life can be described from two directions. From below, awe is the first discipline that makes the self receptive and bounded; love then expands that receptive life toward attachment. From above, love is experienced as the prior divine generosity from which awe is born as response. Se'if 3 will translate the same two directions into the relation of Adnut and Havayah.

17 Honor and reverence: Exodus 20:12 puts father first in honor; Leviticus 19:3 puts mother first in reverence. Kiddushin 30b:18-22 and 31a:1 equate both with God's honor and awe, then explains: a child naturally honors the mother more and fears the father more, so Torah foregrounds the less instinctive duty. Rav Tzadok reads this symbolically through Se'if 1's father/mother principles. Exodus 20:12 Leviticus 19:3 Kiddushin 30b:18-22; 31a:1 The Gemara gives a behavioral explanation for Scripture's reversed order; Rav Tzadok adds a symbolic one without displacing the peshat. Because father and mother already signify source and indwelling manifestation, honor and reverence become clues to two modes of avodah. The key is that neither parent, and neither spiritual quality, is dispensable. The Torah's reversal teaches complementarity: healthy service requires both receptive awe and active love, ordered according to what the situation demands.

18 The two wings: Rav cites Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 10: Torah without fear and love does not rise. Tanya 40-41 explains that love and fear are not substitutes for action but its two wings. Rav Tzadok's Resisei Layla 10:1 gives the same parallel and aligns the wings with Avraham and Yitzchak. Tikkunei Zohar 25b:2 Tanya 40:10 Tanya 41:13 Resisei Layla 10:1 The wing-image preserves the priority of deed. A bird without wings is still a bird, but it cannot rise; similarly, an act may retain halakhic identity even when its inward love and awe are deficient, yet it lacks the spiritual elevation Rav Tzadok is describing. This distinction is important throughout the se'if. He is analyzing the inner fruit of mitzvah, not rewriting the legal conditions of mitzvah performance. Love and fear vivify the deed rather than replace it. Exact internal Rav Tzadok parallels — Peri Tzadik, Tzav §8 explicitly calls love and fear ‘the two wings’ and explains the Tikkunei Zohar's statement that Torah with dehilu u-rehimu rises above, connecting the image to Elisha Ba'al Kenafayim. Kometz HaMinchah II §5 gives a second internal formulation: the cherubim signify love, the revolving sword signifies fear, and one reaches the Tree of Life—Torah—by passing through the gates of love and fear. These are direct Rav Tzadok witnesses for the wing-symbolism used here and sharpen the point that ahavah and yirah are the animating powers by which Torah and mitzvah become spiritually elevated. Peri Tzadik, Tzav §8; Kometz HaMinchah II §5.

19 Flight and apprehension: For Rav Tzadok, “flight” means that the mitzvah is received with favor and yields new inward apprehension. It continues Se'if 1: father is transcendent source; mother is contracted vitality bringing potential into awareness. Tanya 16:6-7 likewise says that contemplation invested in action becomes its inner life and wings. Tanya 16:6-7 ‘Flight’ therefore belongs to the afterlife of the act within the soul. When action is joined to kavvanah, the act does more than discharge an obligation: it becomes a vehicle of new perception. Rav Tzadok's developmental sequence is precise - rooted vitality, felt heart-awareness, embodied mitzvah, and then expanded apprehension. The language of wings captures the transition from a bounded act to a consciousness capable of rising beyond the level from which the act began.

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עבודת זרה Avodah Zarah

א סעיף א — Avodah Zarah § 1

The Festivals of the Nations: Joy and Its Opposite; True Tranquility Rests on Trust in Hashem

ג. - **Gimel**.¹ (א - [In] Avodah Zarah (2a): one taught “eideihen” (their calamities) and one taught “idiheihehen” (their testimonies). ופירוש הוראות שם חג הוא על שמחה [וועיין בערוך ב' גאון דהוא על הרקידה מלשון יחוגו וגוועו. ורקידה היינו מתוך השמחה וכמו שכתוב בשמחת And the meaning of the term “chag” (festival) is [an expression] of joy [and see in the Aruch, in the name of a Gaon, that it is [an expression] of dancing, from the language “they reel and stagger,” and dancing is [done] out of joy, as they said regarding the rejoicing of bride and groom, “How does one dance before the bride?” (Kesubos 16b)]; וילכך and therefore an unspecified “chag” [refers] only to the festival of Sukkos, which is the time of our joy. - And likewise the word can denote its opposite as well.² וכמו שכתבתי במקום אחר כי כל שורשי לשון הקודש מורים דבר והיפוכו. - As I wrote elsewhere, all the roots of the holy tongue can indicate a thing and its opposite. This is from the “Gate of Substitutions,” as is known: “God made this corresponding to that.” And what stands opposite is its literal opposite. [כמו דרך משל אדם העומד נגד חברו מה שאצל זה ימין אצל זה שמאל. - For example, when one person stands facing another, what is right for one appears as left for the other opposite him.] - והיינו דרך משל מה שהוא שמחה אצל זה - there is also joy for the other, yet for this one it is grief; and the joy opposed to true joy is a joy of frivolity (hollelus).³ ואסריתה תונה. וכן היא גם באותה - It lasts only for the moment, - והיא רק לפי שעה - and its end is grief. Even at that very moment it is grief to one who is not given to imagination, and to something that lasts only for a time. - למהות דבוקים בדמיון ובדבר שהוא לפי שעה, - וכמו שכתוב (יבמות ק"ג ע"ב) כל טובתן של רשעים - As they said (Yevamos 103b): “All the good of the wicked is evil in the eyes of the righteous.” - וגם זה נקרא חג כמו שכתוב והיתה וגו' למצרים לחגא - This too is called “chag,” as it is said: “And [the land of Yehuda] will become” etc., “a dread (chaga) to Egypt.” - אבל השמחה האמיתית היא השמחה בדי' - But the true joy is the joy in Hashem; whereas the festivals of the gentile nations and their joy — their end is woe, מאחר שהיא רק כמו, - בבעבודה זרה ואינו דבר הקיים לעד - since it is in idolatry and is not a thing that endures forever, - but [is] only like “before a fall, [there is] haughtiness, - לפני שבר גאון - and its end is their calamity and a shattering,”⁴ - והתמורות

1 Avodah Zarah 2a preserves two readings of the tractate's opening word, one associated with the nations' calamities and one with their testimony. Rav Tzadok treats the doubleness as programmatic: the same encounter with Divine truth can become joy or judgment. The Arukh connects chag with circular dancing, while Isaiah 19:17 uses the related form chagah for dread; Rav Tzadok uses the contrast to introduce his principle that holy language can disclose opposite manifestations of one root. Avodah Zarah 2a; Isaiah 19:17; Arukh, s.v. chag.

2 The Aruch, s.v. chag, in the name of a Gaon: festival-joy as dancing, from “they reel and stagger (yachogu ve-yanu'u)” (Tehillim 107:27); with Kesubos 16b: “how does one dance before the bride?” — dancing as joy's body. Avodah Zarah 2a: The tractate opens by validating two readings, one of festival/calamity and one of testimony. Rav Tzadok treats the textual doubleness as programmatic: the same encounter with Divine truth can become joy or judgment. The discourse opens from the Mishnah's opening word (Avodah Zarah 2a): one master reads eideihen (the nations' “calamities”), another idiheihehen (their “testimonies”) — the dispute hinging on the word for the nations' festivals. “Chag” denotes joy (the Aruch: dancing, yachogu ve-yanu'u), and hence setam chag is Sukkos, zman simchaseinu. Rav Tzadok's principle: every root of the holy tongue denotes a thing and its opposite — the sha'ar ha-temuros (Pardes), grounded in zeh le-umas zeh asah Elokim (Koheles 7:14), where “corresponding” means the exact opposite.

3 The “Gate of Substitutions” (Sha'ar HaTemuros; Pardes Rimonim of R' Moshe Cordovero): the roots of the holy tongue denote a thing and its opposite — “He made the one corresponding to the other” (Koheles 7:14); so chag is also chaga, “a dread to Egypt” (Yeshayahu 19:17); with Yevamos 103b: “all the good of the wicked is evil in the eyes of the righteous” — the frivolous joy (hollelus, Koheles 2:2) woeful even at its hour. 480 Applied to joy: what is joy to one is woe to another. The joy set against true joy is the joy of frivolity (hollelus) — only for a time, ending in woe; and even at the moment it is woe to one not given to dimyon (illusion). Yevamos 103b: kol tovasan shel resha'im ra'ah hi etzel tzaddikim — “all the good of the wicked is evil in the eyes of the righteous.” The same word chag carries this reversal — Yeshayahu 19:17, ve-haysah... le-Mitzrayim le-chaga, where chaga means dread, not festival.

4 Mishlei 14:10: “the heart knows its own bitterness, and in its joy no stranger shall intrude” — joy as untroubled tranquility of heart, possible only in trust; Yayikra 23:43: “for in booths I caused the Children of Israel to dwell” — Sukkos, the unspecified chag, as sheltering in His shadow: the joy itself the deposition of trust; with Mishlei 16:18: “before a fall — haughtiness.” True joy is joy in Hashem; the nations' festival-joy ends in woe, being in idolatry and

from the Gate of Substitutions. And this too is “their testimony,” for joy is the tranquility of the heart without any worry, and as it is said “and in his joy no stranger shall intrude, [there being] only what his heart feels [as] tranquility and joy; and this matter is impossible except for one whose heart is steadfast, secure in Hashem, [confident] that it is in His power to save us, and [that] there is nothing over which we should worry and for which we should not hope upon Him for the salvation of Hashem;”⁵ and one who is confident with such a trust is able to be in the true tranquility. And this is the matter of the festival of Sukkos, which is the time of joy — and at the time of tranquility he is recognized [as to] that is, by reason of “for in booths [I caused the Children of Israel to dwell]” etc., which is the sheltering in the shadow of Hashem and the confidence in His salvation; and the joy and true tranquility, without any worry, testifies to the truth of his trust.

And therefore they said — and the middle line among them is “in his cup, Wine gladdens the heart of man” — and as it is said “Wine gladdens the heart of man” — and at the time of tranquility he is recognized [as to] from where his tranquility is drawn, by reason of which [object of] trust;⁶ Israel, when they eat and drink, engage in words of song and praise, [so] that it is recognized that their tranquility is from Hashem; but the gentile nations engage in words of vulgarity and harlotry. And this is [because] their tranquility is from the side of idolatry — [it is] from the side of the [objects of] trust in this deceitful world and their false pleasures; and so their tranquility and joy is falsehood and imagination, and therefore their festival and joy for idolatry — this is “their testimony” upon the walls of their heart, for [each one] is steadfastly confident in the vanities of idolatry.⁸

Avodah Zarah § 2 — דְּבַר הַבַּיִת

The Joy of Mitzvah and Ru'ach HaKodesh; Truth United with Faith

And likewise the opposite: the joy of mitzvah, which is the joy of the Children of Israel,⁹ which testifies to

not enduring — lifnei shever ga'on (Mishlei 16:18), its end eideihen (calamity) and shattering. And yet it is also “their testimony” (idiheihehen), because joy is tranquility of heart without any worry (u-ve-simchaso lo yisarev zar, Mishlei 14:10). Such untroubled tranquility is possible only for one whose heart is secure, confident in Hashem's power to save — with nothing to fear and nothing for which he does not hope to Him.

5 This is the inner meaning of Sukkos, zman simchaseinu: the booth is ki va-sukkos hoshavti (Vayikra 23:43) — the sheltering in the shadow of Hashem and confidence in His salvation. The true, untroubled joy testifies to the truth of one's trust. Both readings thus hold together: a person's festival testifies (idiheihehen) to where his security lies — and for the nations, whose security rests on idolatry, that same testimony is also their calamity (eideihen), since the object of their trust cannot endure.

6 Eruvin 65b: “in three things a person is known: in his cup, in his purse, and in his anger” — the cup the middle diagnostic (“wine gladdens the heart of man,” Tehillim 104:15); Megillah 12b: Israel at food and drink engage in words of song and praise, the nations in vulgarity and harlotry — tranquility's source revealed at the hour of rest. 481 Eruvin 65b: bi-shloshe devarim adam nikar — a person is known by three things — the middle one being “be-koso” (in his cup), for yayin yesamach levav enosh (Tehillim 104:15). In tranquility one is revealed: from what object of trust his tranquility flows. Megillah 12b: Israel, eating and drinking, engage in song and praise — revealing their tranquility is from Hashem — while the nations engage in vulgarity and harlotry.

7 The diagnosis: the nations' tranquility is from idolatry — resting on trust in this deceitful world and its false pleasures, so their tranquility and joy is itself falsehood and imagination (sheker ve-dimyon). Hence their festival of joy for idolatry is “their testimony upon the walls of their heart” — the festival publicly attests where each one is steadfastly confident: in the vanities of idolatry. Joy is thus a reliable witness to the object of one's trust, which is why the same word names both the celebration and what it exposes.

8 Lasting joy versus momentary pleasure. Maharal distinguishes simchah rooted in true shlemut from amusement that vanishes because it has no enduring form. Rav Tzadok's ‘joy of frivolity’ versus joy in Hashem follows the same ontological line. Resisei Layla and Divrei Soferim likewise connect true joy with a heart straightened through yirah and Torah rather than with the absence of restraint. Resisei Layla, ch. 6: Rav Tzadok elsewhere makes holy joy a diagnostic sign of completed, accepted avodah. This is especially close to the Avodah Zarah discourse's distinction between enduring simchah and passing amusement.

9 Shabbos 30b: The Bavli distinguishes simchah shel mitzvah from levity. Rav Tzadok uses that exact boundary to define joy as a sign that an act is attached to its holy source rather than to passing stimulation. Joy and ruach ha-kodesh.

their faith (emunah) and to the tranquility of their heart, וּמִצְדָּה הַזֶּה הוּא שְׂמֵחָה בְּלִבָּם לֹא זִלְזוּלָה [in] that it is steadfast and confident in Hashem. And it is from this side that the joy is drawn in their heart, not otherwise; (שְׂבִיבָה לִי ע"ב) - and this is called "the joy of mitzvah," [and] by means of it they come to ru'ach ha-kodesh, as the Sages said (Shabbos 30b) that ru'ach ha-kodesh rests [on a person] out of the joy of mitzvah;¹⁰ and likewise they said (Yerushalmi Sukkah 5:1) regarding the Rejoicing of the [Water-]Drawing House on the festival, that from there they draw ru'ach ha-kodesh. - as is known, that ru'ach ha-kodesh is the level of faith, - He in truth and she in faith" — meaning, Hashem is called "Truth," for He is the absolute Truth that endures forever and to all eternity; and when a person recognizes this with a complete [clarity of] sight, that [it is] truth, clear and lucid, - then it is called "truth." But so long as it is not discernible to the eye, [and is] only in concealment and the darkness of night [yet] he believes [it] so with complete faith and trusts in it — and faith is [that which is held] not by reason of the intellect — this is the trait of Knesses Yisrael. And in faith there is also "the simpleton believes everything" — [in] that the worshipers of stars and constellations also believe in their idolatry. And as the Sages said (Shemos Rabbah 27) [that] "the simpleton becomes cunning" — this is Yisro, who left no idolatry in the world that he did not worship (Devarim Rabbah 1:5), and would believe everything. כי אִשְׁתּוֹ וְנִגְוִים מִתְּתַקְנָה בְּרִצָּא שֶׁתִּלְכֵּן כִּמוֹ שֶׁכְּתוּב בְּזוֹהַר תְּרוּמָה. For "a woman of harlotry grows jealous of the mystery of a woman of valor," as they said in the Zohar (Terumah 148b), and it concludes "but she could not."¹² ומִסְתִּימָה וְלֹא יָכִילָהּ. "And this is [the matter]: that truth and faith are united, - and the faith of Hashem cleaves to Hashem, who is Truth, and the Truth flows within it. This is not so [with the nations] — their faith cleaves to falsehood, and that spirit which her husband leaves with her is called, with them, "the spirit of impurity."¹³

Shabbos 30b teaches that the Shechinah does not rest amid sadness or frivolity but amid joy of mitzvah; Yerushalmi Sukkah 5:1 explains the joy of Beit HaShoevah as a place from which ruach ha-kodesh was drawn. Rav Tzadok therefore treats simchah as evidence of emunah only when the joy itself is mitzvah-formed. Resisei Layla, ch. 6: Rav Tzadok elsewhere makes holy joy a diagnostic sign of completed, accepted avodah. This is especially close to the Avodah Zarah discourse's distinction between enduring simchah and passing amusement.

10 Shabbos 30b: the Shechinah rests "neither out of sadness nor out of levity... but out of the joy of mitzvah"; Yerushalmi Sukkah 5:1: the Rejoicing of the Water-Drawing House — "from there they drew ru'ach ha-kodesh": joy as the conduit of the spirit. The Bavli distinguishes simchah shel mitzvah from levity. Rav Tzadok uses that exact boundary to define joy as a sign that an act is attached to its holy source rather than to passing stimulation. The mirror image of §1: the joy of mitzvah, the joy of Israel, testifies to their emunah and to the tranquility of a heart secure in Hashem. From this source the joy is drawn, and through simcha shel mitzvah one attains ru'ach ha-kodesh (Shabbos 30b; Yerushalmi Sukkah 5:1, the Simchas Beis HaShoe'ivah from which they draw ru'ach ha-kodesh). This is the reward of faith, for ru'ach ha-kodesh is the level of emunah — the Zoharic ihu be-emes ve-ihu be-emunah ("He in truth, she in faith").

11 The Zoharic pair "He in truth and she in faith" (ihu emes ve-ihu emunah) — "and Hashem, God, is Truth" (Yirmiyahu 10:10): truth the enduring, seen clear and lucid; faith the same content held in night and concealment, "not by reason of the intellect" — the trait of Knesses Yisrael. 482 The distinction between emes and emunah: Hashem is "Truth" — the absolute, eternal truth; when a person recognizes this with complete clarity of sight, it is called "truth" (emes). But when it is not visible to the eye — in concealment, the darkness of night — and one nonetheless believes it with complete faith and trusts in it, that faith held not by the intellect is the trait of Knesses Yisrael (emunah). Emunah is the feminine receptivity that holds the truth precisely where it cannot yet be seen — the rung from which the festival-joy and ru'ach ha-kodesh flow.

12 Mishlei 14:15: "the simpleton believes everything" — credulity's two valences; Shemos Rabbah 27: "the simpleton becomes cunning" — Yisro; Devarim Rabbah 1:5: Yisro "left no idolatry in the world that he did not worship" — the omnivorous believer become the convert of converts. But faith has a counterfeit: pesi ya'amin le-chol davar (Mishlei 14:15), "the simpleton believes everything" — the nations too believe in their idolatry. Shemos Rabbah 27 / Devarim Rabbah 1:5: u-fesi ya'arim — this is Yisro, who left no idolatry unworshipped, believing all. The Zohar (Terumah 148b): the "woman of harlotry" grows jealous of the mystery of the "woman of valor" — but "she could not" prevail. Faith as such is neutral; everything turns on its object.

13 Zohar, Terumah 148b: "a woman of harlotry grows jealous of the mystery of a woman of valor... but she could not" — the counterfeit's limit; with the doctrine of the spirit the husband leaves in his wife: joined to falsehood, "the spirit of impurity"; joined to Truth, ru'ach ha-kodesh — faith's identical posture, opposite issue. The decisive difference: